

 OR-AS Operations Research Applications and Solutions	Case Name: Railway Station (2)	Sector	Construction (civil)	
	OR-AS Operations Research - Applications and Solutions www.or-as.be info@or-as.be	Baseline Schedule	Schedule with resources	
			Schedule with costs	
		Risk Analysis	Random simulation	
Submitted by	Matilde Casado and Margarida Antunes		One of nine std. scenarios	
Date	2015		User defined distributions	
File Name	C2015-09 Railway Station (2)		Project Control	Automatic tracking
			Tracking based on user input	

1. Project description

Project authenticity

A railway station construction project involving foundation, infrastructure, superstructure, and finishing works for modernization and accessibility.

The project consists of activity, resource and cost data that were obtained directly from the actual project owner.

2. Project properties

2.1. Baseline Schedule

General		Network topology	
# Activities	348	Serial/Parallel (SP)	4%
Planned Duration (PD)	354 days*	Activity Distribution (AD)	48%
Budget At Completion (BAC)	1 457 424.0€	Length of Arcs (LA)	0%
Renewable Resources	-	Topological Float (TF)	75%
Consumable Resources	-		

* standard eight-hour working days

2.2. Risk Analysis

Random simulation by ProTrack was performed using the default symmetric triangular risk distribution profiles.

	Cost sensitivity				Time sensitivity		
	avg [%]	std dev [%]	skew [-]		avg [%]	std dev [%]	skew [-]
CRI-r	5.8	8.3	-2.7	CI	4.3	13.7	-3.3
CRI-rho	25.0	20.9	-0.3	SI	13.6	21.5	-2.1
CRI-tau	92.0	22.7	-0.5	SSI	1.3	4.7	-5.3
				CRI-r	8.6	6.9	-1.2
				CRI-rho	8.7	6.6	-1.3
				CRI-tau	8.2	6.3	-0.9
	Resource sensitivity						
	avg [%]	std dev [%]	skew [-]				
CRI-r	N/A	N/A	N/A				
CRI-rho	N/A	N/A	N/A				
CRI-tau	N/A	N/A	N/A				

2.3. Project Control

2.3.1. Simulated forecasting accuracy

The accuracy of time and cost forecasting methods has been evaluated based on Monte Carlo simulation runs using the risk profiles described in section “2.2. Risk Analysis”. Based on these risk profiles, the Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE) and Mean Percentage Error (MPE) has been calculated to evaluate the expected accuracy of the time and cost predictions, EAC(t) and EAC, respectively.

Simulated EAC(t) accuracy			Simulated EAC accuracy		
method - PF	MAPE [%]	MPE [%]	method (PF)	MAPE [%]	MPE [%]
PV - 1	28.8	28.1	1	2.3	0.0
PV - SPI	49.3	48.8	CPI	2.5	0.3
PV - SCI	49.8	48.8	SPI	19.5	19.4
ED - 1	52.7	51.8	SPI(t)	17.5	17.4
ED - SPI	49.3	48.7	SCI	19.5	19.5
ED - SCI	49.4	48.8	SCI(t)	17.6	17.5
ES - 1	23.8	23.5	0.8 CPI + 0.2 SPI	9.0	8.9
ES - SPI(t)	36.5	36.3	0.8 CPI + 0.2 SPI(t)	9.1	8.6
ES - SCI(t)	36.5	36.3			

According to the MAPE values¹ the best performance for time forecasting can be expected from the unweighted Earned Schedule method. For cost forecasting the unweighted and CPI-weighted methods should yield the best results.

2.3.2. Tracking description

Tracking authenticity

Manual tracking was performed over 9 tracking periods with a length of approximately 3 months. The Real Duration and Real Cost mentioned in section “2.3.3. Earned Value Management” are based on manual user input.

The tracking information obtained from the project owner and introduced in ProTrack includes actual activity start dates, durations and costs.

¹ The MAPE gives the best indication for the forecast accuracy (the lower the MAPE, the more accurate the method) since all deviations from the targeted real duration (real cost) are cumulated, whereas for the MPE underestimates can be compensated by overestimates and vice versa, possibly leading to an overly positive evaluation of a certain method. However, the MPE can provide useful information about the nature of the deviations, i.e. does the method rather underestimate or overestimate the real duration (real cost)?

2.3.3. Earned Value Management

2.3.3.1. Performance metrics

	CV [€]	SV [€]	SV(t) [d]	CPI [-]	SPI [-]	SPI(t) [-]	p-factor [-]
avg	-194018.9	-385965.0	-1013.0	0.8	0.6	0.6	0.9
std dev	222839.3	383228.2	515.1	0.1	0.3	0.1	0.1
final	-688253.0	-403182.1	-1728.0	0.7	1.0	0.6	1.0

2.3.3.2. Time forecasting

PD	354 days	Real Duration	570 days	Late	61.0%
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EAC(t)	Real Accuracy			
method - PF	avg [d]	std dev [d]	MAPE [%]	MPE [%]
PV - 1	362.2	2.1	4.1	4.1
PV - SPI	362.7	2.1	4.0	4.0
PV - SCI	363.4	2.1	4.0	4.0
ED - 1	364.2	1.9	4.0	4.0
ED - SPI	365.0	1.9	4.0	4.0
ED - SCI	365.7	1.9	4.0	4.0
ES - 1	366.5	2.1	4.0	4.0
ES - SPI(t)	367.2	2.1	4.0	4.0
ES - SCI(t)	367.7	2.1	3.9	3.9

2.3.3.3. Cost forecasting

BAC	14 574 234.0€	Real Cost	2 145 682.3€	Over Budget	47.2%
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EAC	Real Accuracy			
method (PF)	avg [€]	std dev [€]	MAPE [%]	MPE [%]
1	1651448.2	222839.3	2.6	2.6
CPI	1862549.4	182035.0	1.5	1.5
SPI	2646603.8	1051066.2	2.6	-2.6
SPI(t)	2389528.9	278309.9	1.3	-1.3
SCI	3121589.1	1413224.6	5.1	-5.1
SCI(t)	2771365.5	475311.3	3.2	-3.2
0.8 CPI + 0.2 SPI	1939169.5	190188.6	1.1	1.1
0.8 CPI + 0.2 SPI(t)	1936197.7	149353.9	1.1	1.1